



YOU ARE **8 WEEKS AND 3 DAYS**

221 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

In a matter of days, your baby's eyes have developed from slight ridges to clear depressions, on each side of the face. The face is developing rapidly at this stage, and your baby's heartbeat would be seen on an ultrasound scan.

“It's a few weeks before the hormone responsible for morning sickness subsides, but the nausea will pass soon.”

You may be wondering when you'll wake up and no longer feel sick. HCG (human chorionic gonadotropin) levels, which may be responsible for feelings of nausea, will begin to fall in about three weeks' time and most women begin to feel better then. For some women the sickness may continue beyond this time.

You may have just started to feel nauseous or your sickness may have begun weeks ago and now be worse, but by around week 12 you should be over the worst. Nausea that happens daily, especially if it is associated with fatigue, can be very wearing so try to remember that it's temporary.

It's normal to have some morning sickness and you should be able to keep some foods and fluids down. However, for a small minority of pregnant women—about 1 percent—the vomiting is severe, occurring regularly and lasting over a period of weeks. This more serious form of morning sickness is called hyperemesis gravidarum and can lead to dehydration. Hospital treatment with intravenous fluids and anti-nausea drugs may be required to rehydrate you.

Seek advice from your doctor if you're concerned about the amount of times you're vomiting or if you're struggling to keep fluids and food down.

About 70–80 percent of pregnant women suffer from nausea and vomiting. If you are one of the 20–30 percent who don't, be thankful. You may get anxious if you're not feeling sick because it is such a common symptom, but don't worry and just count yourself lucky.

EXERCISE AND NAUSEA

If you're feeling particularly nauseated, try going for a brisk walk while concentrating on your breathing and posture. Sometimes taking frequent sips of water helps these feelings and will allow you to exercise longer. Regular exercisers may find that nausea is absent during exercise, although it may resume after the session. Slow yoga moves can help with nausea. Be careful—extreme nausea and vomiting can be a sign of overexercising. Drink water before, during, and after physical activity.